

FROM MENDOZA'S SUN TO MICHIGAN'S SNOW

Two Worlds, One Remarkable Journey



ARE THE RULES THE SAME?

Realities, Clashes & Opportunities

When we think about a career, we imagine a familiar routine. But what happens when the game board changes completely?

- ✓ **Valentín:** Living the dream at Michigan Tech.
- ✓ **Laureano:** The newcomer from Malargüe.



Transitioning from the Southern Hemisphere's warmth to the Northern Tier's academic rigor.

A TALE OF TWO SYSTEMS



Distinct Philosophies

It's not about which is better; it's about how the rules differ. One allows for peaks, the other demands unrelenting daily precision.

Academic Currency

Argentina: The "Final Exam" culture
USA: The "Credit & GPA" accumulation

THE ARGENTINE REALITY

- ✓ **Annual/Semester Blocks:** Long-term curriculum pacing.
- ✓ **Mandatory Finals:** Everything is defined in the big final exam.
- ✓ **"Regular" vs "Promoted":** Strategies to skip finals or stay in the game.
- ✓ **Static Peers:** You start and end with the same group of friends.



THE MICHIGAN TECH SYSTEM



- ✓ **Credit Accumulation:** Every course counts toward your total.
- ✓ **No "Saving it for the Final":** Continuous tasks, quizzes, and weekly projects.
- ✓ **GPA Criticality:** A single failure can severely damage your average.
- ✓ **Floating Peers:** New classmates every subject, diverse social networking.

STUDY RHYTHMS: PEAKS VS CONSTANCY

Argentina: Final Exam Peaks

Intense Bursts

USA: Daily Discipline

Continuous Effort

"In Argentina you survive with peaks; in the USA, you survive with military-grade discipline."

| AUTODISCIPLINE: THE HUB

Extreme Organization

If you don't organize your schedule in Michigan, the system will run you over. But you aren't alone.



| THE COST OF "FREE" EDUCATION

A large yellow icon consisting of the number '0' followed by a dollar sign '\$'.

Tuition (Public Universities)



The Hidden Costs

Rent, Food, Transportation, and
Supplies.



Mendoza/Local

Living costs remain even if the
university is free.

THE SCHOLARSHIP OASIS



- ✓ **Travel:** Municipality covers one round-trip flight.
- ✓ **Supplies:** Free printing and text-books included or borrowed.
- ✓ **Infrastructure:** Full access to library and world-class labs.
- ✓ **Economic Peace:** Focus solely on your academic growth.

THE LOGISTICAL HURDLE: WINTER

THE "DETACHMENT" MOMENT

During the Winter Recess (Christmas), the campus shuts down. This is the only time you must activate your own logistics:

- ✓ Campus housing and dining are unavailable.
- ✓ Plan your stay (Walmart runs, cooking, and off-campus housing).
- ✓ Self-sufficiency becomes a mandatory skill.

BEYOND THE BOOKS: ADAPTATION

TOTAL RECONSTRUCTION

You aren't just changing classes; you are reconstructing your routine, your language, and your social circle from scratch.



| THE "DETACHMENT" FACTOR

Leaving Home Behind

The hardest part isn't academic—it's emotional. Dejar a la familia, los amigos, y los domingos de asado en Mendoza.

The US culture is structured, independent, and initially distant compared to Argentine warmth.



| US CULTURE: STRUCTURED & DIRECT



Independent

Respect for time and direct communication.



Diverse

Interact with students from every continent.



Floating Classes

Constant social adaptation is a core skill.

THE SNOWY CHALLENGE

Winter in Michigan

Extreme temperatures and heavy snow transform life into an "indoor" experience. But the body adapts, and the landscape is breathtaking.

From -20°C to winter sports, you discover a world previously unknown to a Mendoza native.



LIFE ON CAMPUS: THE WORK BALANCE



Earn while you learn

The system allows you to work on campus if you maintain your grades. Take Valentín's example:

- ✓ Leveraged the heavy snow.
- ✓ Worked as a **Snowboard Instructor**.
- ✓ Gained experience and pocket money simultaneously.

THE LIFELINES AT MICHIGAN TECH

- ✓ **Office Hours:** 1-on-1 time with professors for deep clarification.
- ✓ **Writing Center:** Specialized support for resumes, essays, and technical reports.
- ✓ **Learning Centers:** Peer tutors available for almost every subject.

"If you ask for help, you will receive it."



LAUREANO: THE BRIDGE FROM MALARGÜE



The Hurdle: TOEFL & Preparation

Laureano's base was strong (Physics & Math), but the real filter was the **TOEFL** exam.

- ✓ It's not just knowing English.
- ✓ It's performing under pressure.
- ✓ Demonstrating you can thrive in a US university setting.

RESILIENCE VS DISCIPLINE

Mendoza

Gives you the "resilience" to navigate crises and form deep human bonds.

Michigan

Gives you first-world structure, infinite resources, and work discipline.

The Result

A global professional who can adapt to any environment on earth.

REALITY CHECK: NO MYTHS

CONCEPT	THE MYTH	THE REALITY
USA Experience	It's a vacation / Easy	Brutal academic pressure
Argentina Background	Our level is lower	Solid base in STEM / Resilient

FINAL CONCLUSION

 International Scholarship Partnership Handshake

"It's not about where you start... it's about how far you are willing to go to break the mold."

The effort of preparing, taking the TOEFL, and jumping into the cold is entirely worth it.

QUESTIONS?

Dare to leap. Dare to be a Husky.

Thank you for your attention!

IMAGE SOURCES



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